But there was no time for euphoria, for we were once more having apartment problems. Our year's rent carried us through August, and we now had to make up our minds whether to renew for another year.

It didn't really seem that we had much choice. We had tried, on and off, to find other apartments. We had, for instance, applied for an apartment in Stuyvesant Town, a huge complex being built on the East Side of Manhattan between Fourteenth Street and Twenty-third Street. The trouble was we had never heard anything from it. Nor had we heard from other applications we had made. It looked as though we would have to stay put.

But then, on August 8, my parents had a proposition for us. They owned the house they lived in, remember. They lived downstairs and the tenant lived upstairs. Soon after I had come out of the Army and was looking for an apartment, my parents wondered if I could move in with them, but there was no way they could kick out the tenants and, in any case, I didn't want them to. Living with my parents would offer problems enough without my having to feel guilty about where the previous tenants were living once we had turned them out.

But it now turned out that the tenants were moving out of their own accord. The apartment would be empty and ready for us, and it would be six rooms. How about it?

It put Gertrude and me in an almost unbearable bind. After a full year in a room and a half, six rooms seemed like such space, such palatial luxury. On the other hand, it meant living in the same house with my parents, and neither one of us wanted this. With the best will in the world, my parents would interfere with and restrict our freedom.

My parents then upped the ante by saying they would spend

$1,500 on renovating the tenants' apartment and move in themselves. They would then let us have the superior downstairs apartment—which would mean Gertrude would not have to climb stairs.

On August 21, we made our decision. We would move into my parents' house. It would be our fifth move since we married.

There would be difficulties, of course, quite apart from combining the roles of parents and landlord. For one thing, after five years in small apartments we had never accumulated any significant amount of furniture. We didn't even have a proper bed, since we had always had a Murphy bed, or had made use